

SENATE BILL 1954

By Lowe

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 39,
Chapter 13, Part 5, relative to sexual offenses.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 39-13-518(a)(1)(A), is amended by deleting the subdivision and substituting:

(A) Engaging in three (3) or more incidents of sexual abuse of one (1) or more minor children on separate occasions; provided, that at least one (1) such incident occurred within the county in which the charge is filed and that one (1) such incident occurred on or after July 1, 2026; and

SECTION 2. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 39-13-518(b), is amended by deleting the subsection and substituting:

(b) A person commits continuous sexual abuse of a child who, during a period that is thirty (30) days or more in duration, engages in multiple acts of sexual abuse of a child as defined in subdivision (a)(1).

SECTION 3. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 39-13-518(e), is amended by deleting the subsection and substituting:

(e) The jury must agree unanimously that during a period that is thirty (30) days or more in duration, the defendant committed multiple acts of sexual abuse of a child as defined in subdivision (a)(1).

SECTION 4. This act takes effect July 1, 2026, the public welfare requiring it, and applies to acts committed on or after that date.